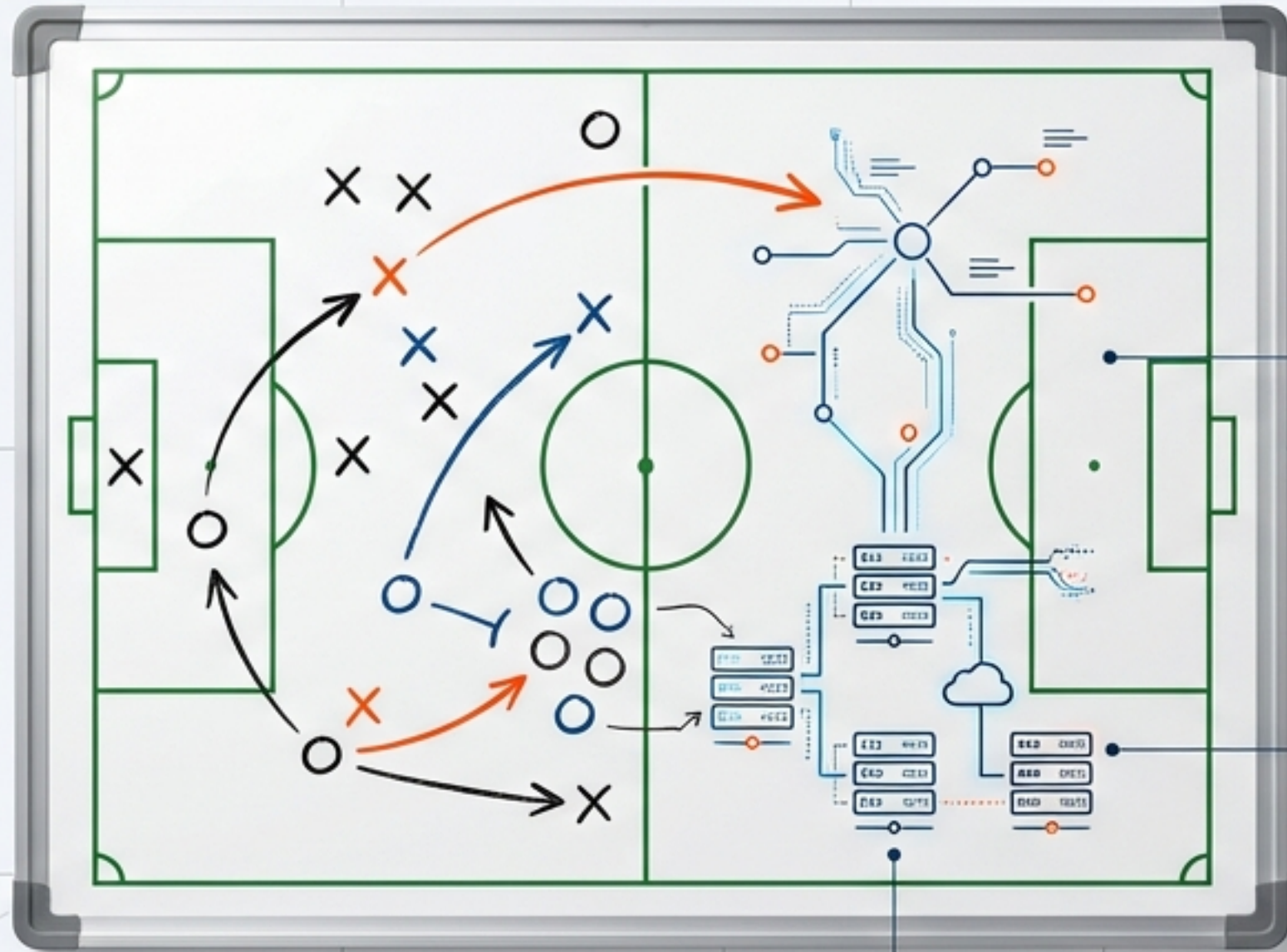


The Football Team: Why Practise Makes Incidents Look Like Exercises

Operational Maturity,
The Preparation Spectrum,
and The End State
(Series Part 5 of 5)



THE BEST COMPLIMENT WE EVER RECEIVED

After months of running P3-as-P1 exercises, we faced a real P1 incident.

Malware had potential to install across the system. It was potentially catastrophic.

The team swarmed.

Within 30 minutes, it was under control.
Within 1 hour, it was wrapped up.

Within 4 hours, it was resolved and documented.

Tactical Orange
(#FF4500)

Academy Blue
(#002147)

INCIDENT MATCH STATS

Status: P1 Critical  **RESOLVED**
 100%

Panic Level:  **0%** **CONTROLLED**

Role Confusion:  **0%** **CLEAR**

Execution Score:  **100%** 

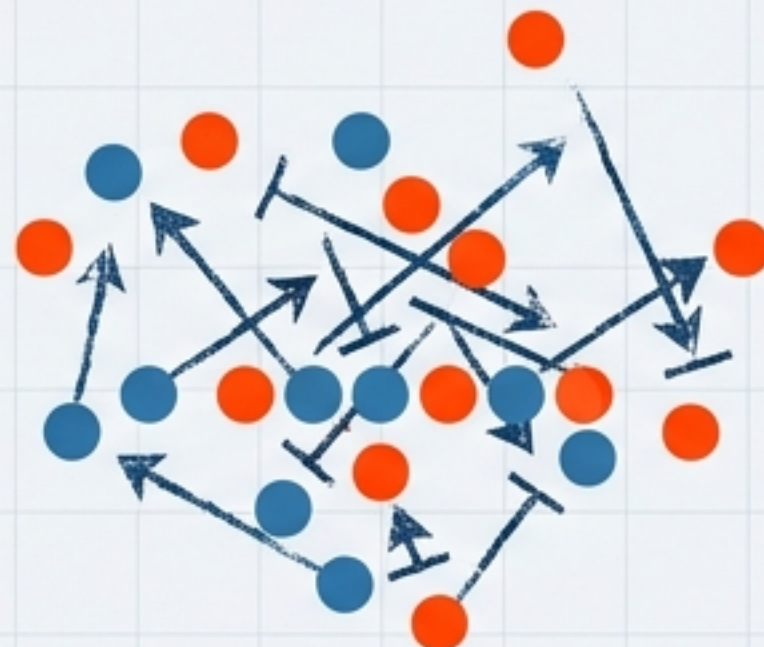
“Observer Quote:
“There is no way this could have been handled like that if it was real. I thought it was a drill.”

Operational capability is the result of **rehearsal**, not luck.



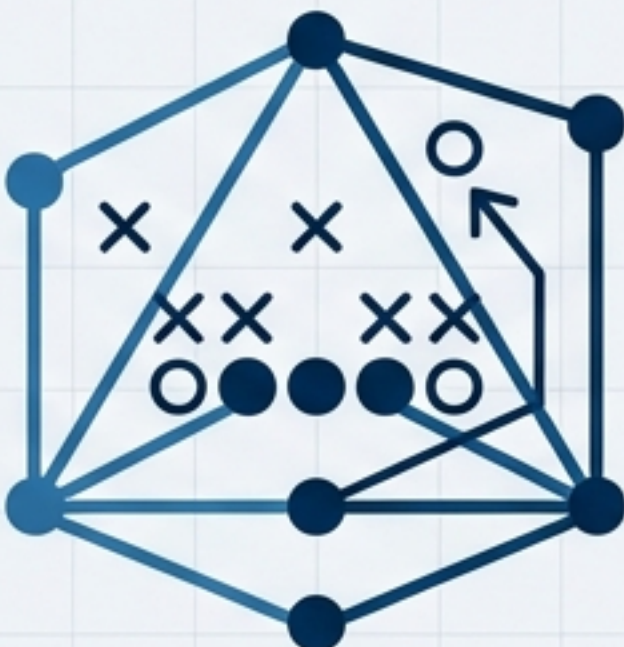
MATCH DAY PERFORMANCE REQUIRES DAILY TRAINING

TEAM A: MATCH DAY ONLY



No shared language. No muscle memory. Reliance on individual talent. Result: **Panic and Loss.**

TEAM B: TRAINS 5 DAYS A WEEK



Drills formations. Rehearses set pieces. Reviews footage. Result: **Execution and Adaptation.**

THE MAPPING:

Training =	P3-as-P1 Approach
Drills =	Minor Incidents
Scrimmages =	Tabletop Exercises
Playbook =	Runbooks
Match Footage =	Incident Database

Do Not Plan the Outcome. Plan the Readjustment.



The **Fallacy**:

"No battle plan survives first contact."
(Used to argue against planning).

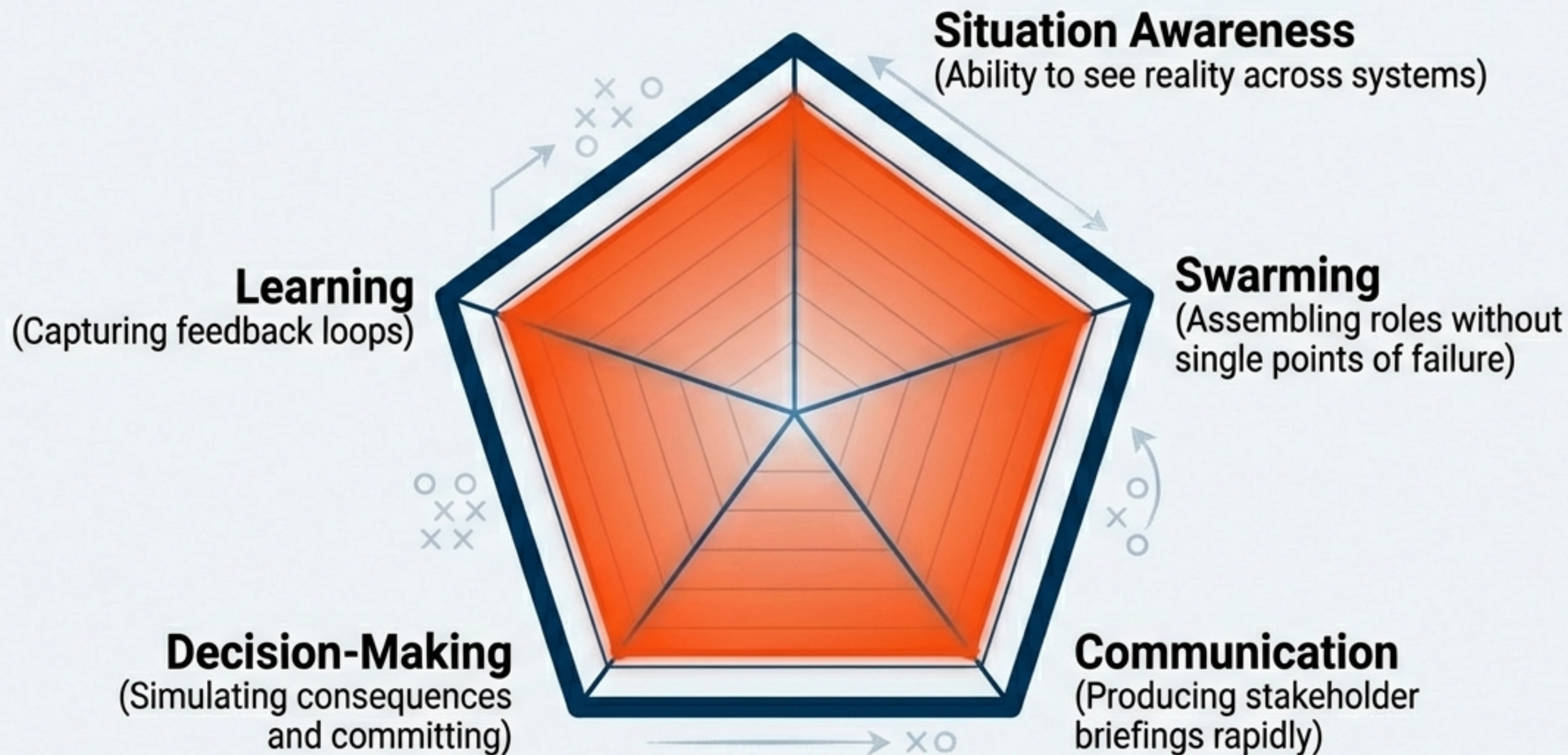
The **Correction**:

Rigid plans fail. Flexible capabilities thrive.
We do not plan specific responses to
predictions. We build the infrastructure to
react, adapt, and readjust.

Key **Concept**:

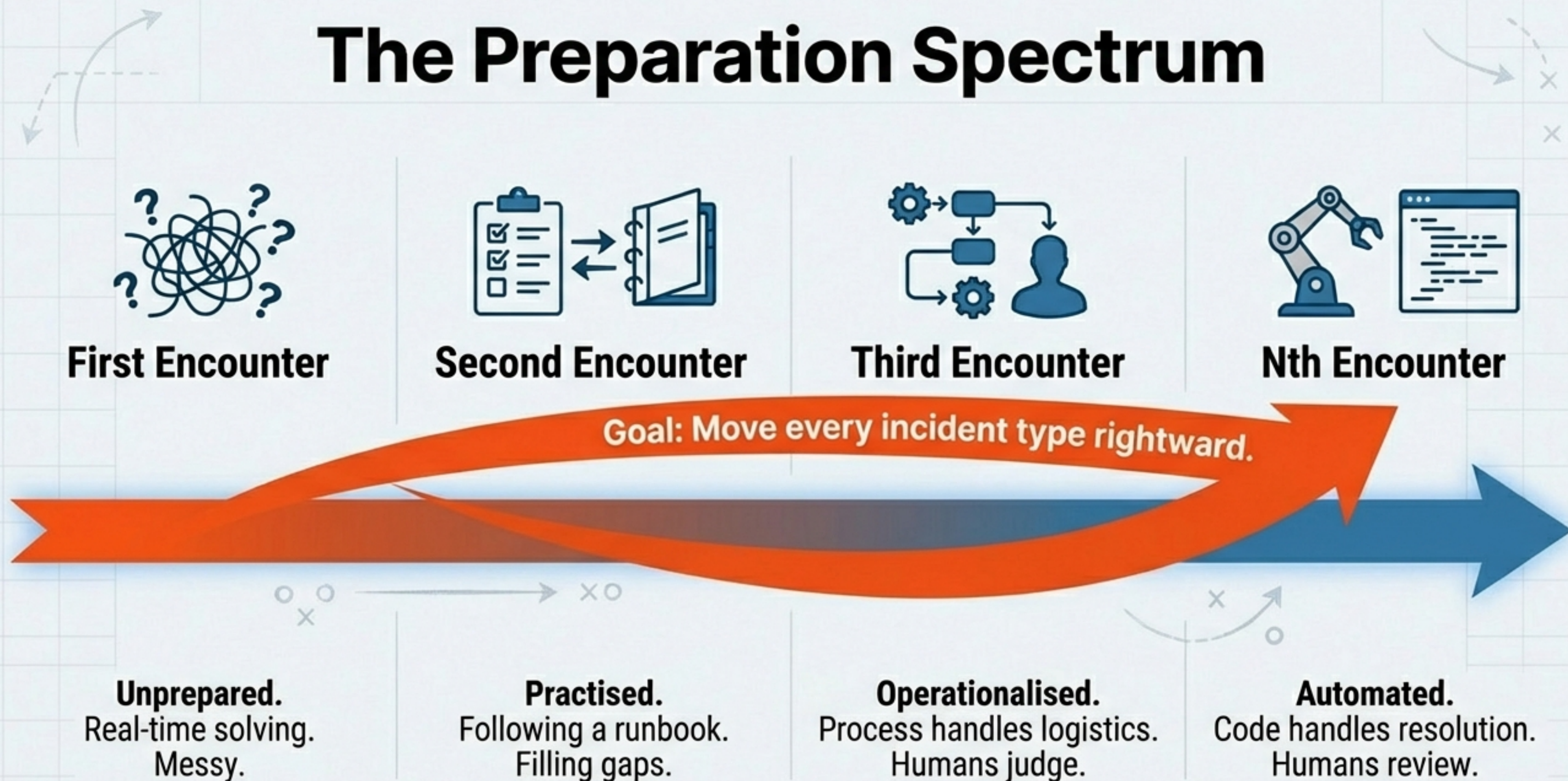
Every interaction with the incident is new
information feeding the next decision.
You bring the machine to react.

THE FIVE CORE CAPABILITIES

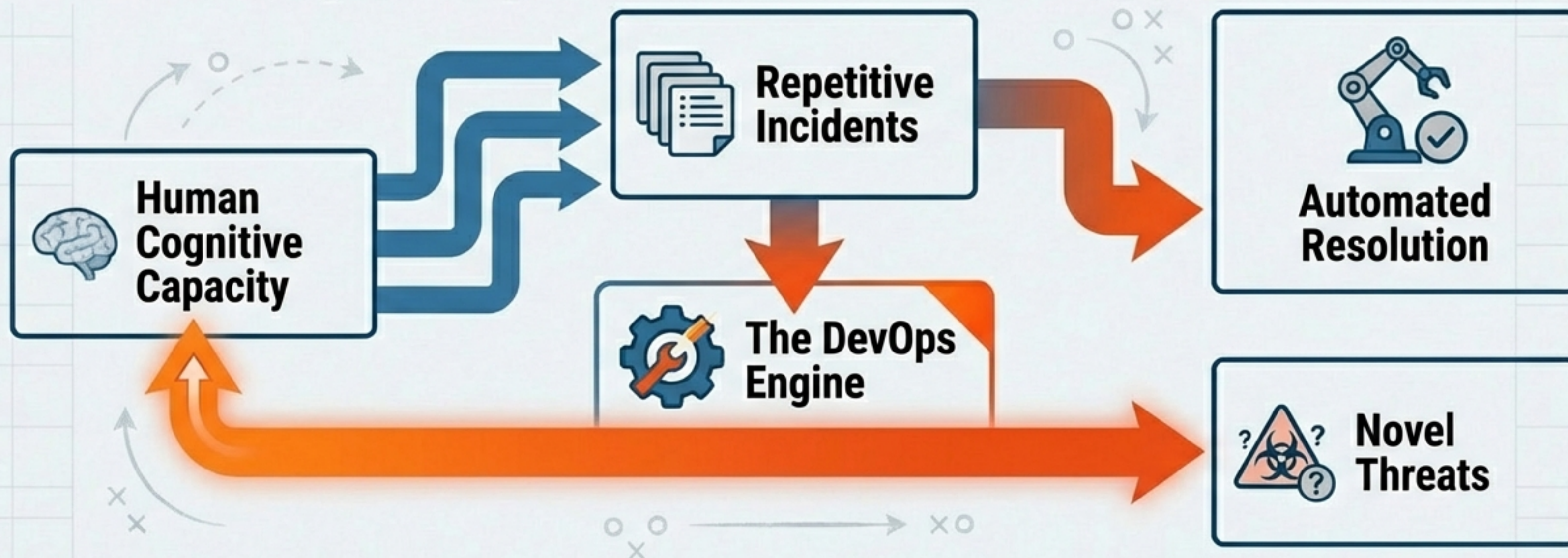


These are infrastructures, not predictions. Capabilities survive contact with the enemy.

The Preparation Spectrum



Rightward Movement Frees Capacity



As specific scenarios move right (toward automation), the team stops fighting the same fires. Capacity is freed to focus on the genuinely novel threats.

Creative Storytelling: The Journalist

Standard Log



14:32:00 WARN: ANOMALY DETECTED
ID-4992: Connection limit
exceeded from IP 192.168.1.105.
Re-attempted 5 times.
Status: Pending Investigation.

Sherpa Trail Flags Unusual Pattern at 14:32



At 14:32, the Sherpa's trail flagged an unusual pattern. Within 15 minutes, the CISO had declared a P3-as-P1 incident as the threat intelligence team pieced together a potential coordinated attack.

The rapid response, driven by the narrative-first reporting, allowed for immediate containment protocols.

By: Incident Response Team

The Problem: Dry post-mortems are ignored. Technical jargon and lack of context fail to engage stakeholders.

The Solution: Write the report as a news story. Narratives draw readers in, highlight urgency, and gamify the documentation process for better retention and action.

Visualising the Blast Radius: The Cartographer

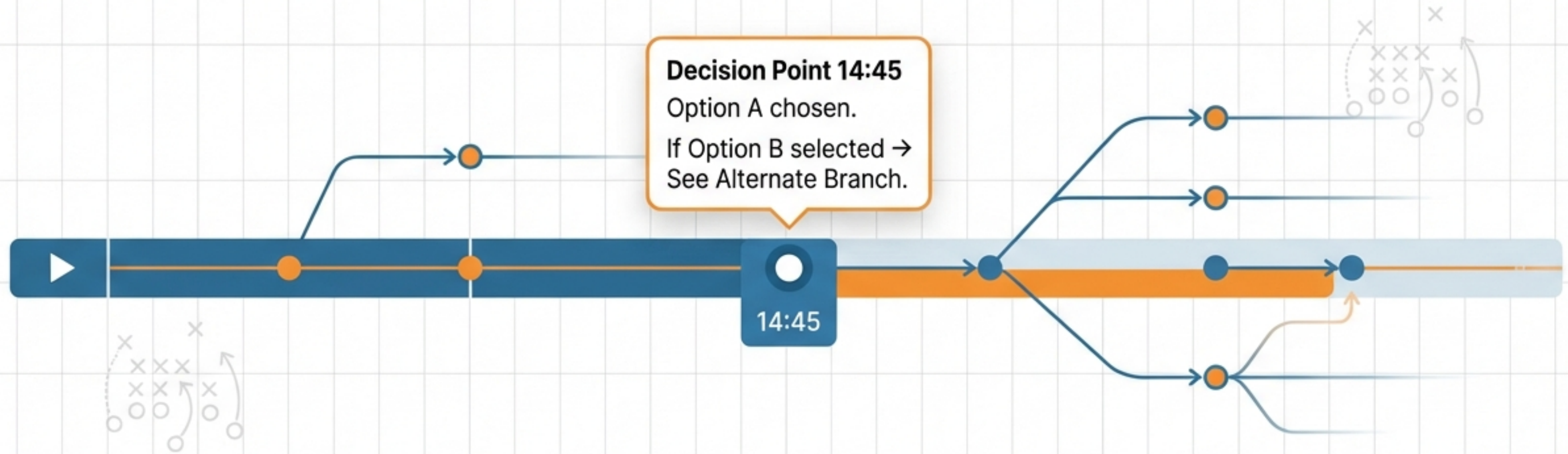


One map is worth a thousand bullet points.

Required Visuals:

1. Blast Radius Maps
2. Dependency Graphs
3. Attack Path Diagrams
4. Response Flow Charts

The Historian & Interactive Replays



The timeline isn't a list; it's a decision tree.

Innovation: Interactive Replays.
Using Issues FS database to
create walkthroughs.

Goal: New agents learn by
stepping through history and
exploring "what if" scenarios.

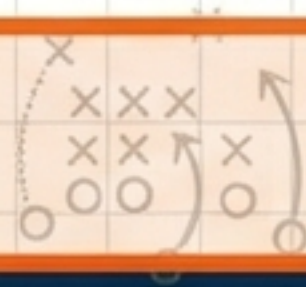
The End State: A Self-Healing System



“We don’t want a perfect system—we want a prepared one.”

The Incident Handling Series Recap

DOCUMENT	SUMMARY
Doc 1: The P3-as-P1 Philosophy	"What could have happened" matters more than "what happened".
Doc 2: Running P3-as-P1 in Practice	Running a minor incident at major-incident quality.
Doc 3: Incidents as the Best Time to Fix Things	The 5x productivity multiplier.
Doc 4: First, Do No Harm	Simulation, communication, and escalation protocols.
Doc 5: The Football Team	Why practise makes real incidents look like exercises.



Role Expectations: Strategy & Memory

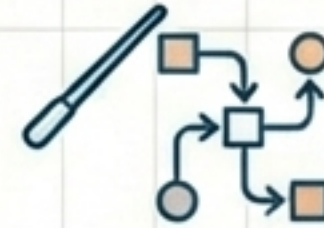
CISO



Owens the philosophy.
Writes the retrospective.
Ensures culture
internalisation.



The Conductor



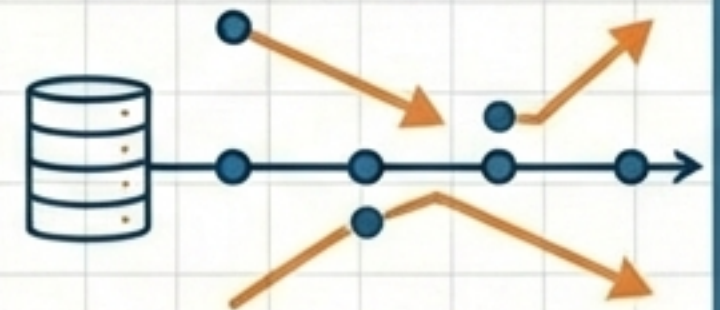
Tracks the Preparation
Spectrum.
Plans the exercises.
Goal is rightward
movement.



The Historian & Librarian



Owens institutional memory.
Indexes incidents.
Tracks trends: Response
times down? Automation
up?



Role Expectations: Execution & Creativity



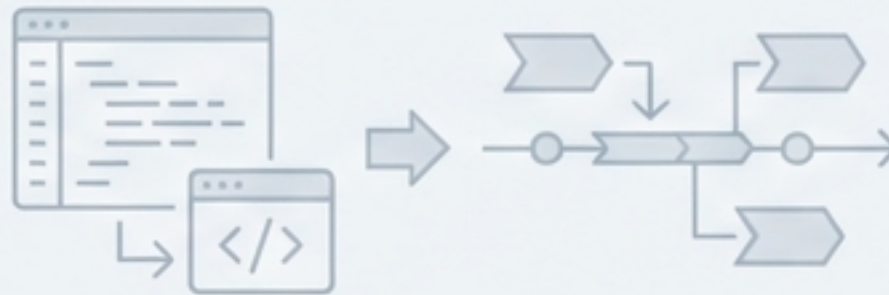
Journalist & Cartographer

Makes learning engaging. Write news stories. Draw blast radius maps. Build the reading culture.



DevOps

The engine of automation. Codifies runbooks into software. Moves incidents rightward.



QA

Builds the safety net. Converts incident failures into permanent regression tests.



All Roles

Raise the weak signal. "How come this was possible?" is always a valid question.

Not a Perfect System. A Prepared One.

